Base44

for Dummies

A PLAIN-LANGUAGE MANUAL

Apps, websites, data, publish, and Superagents, explained without the builder jargon.

PREPARED BY

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ABOUT THIS MANUAL

How to read this book

This manual treats Base44 the way a good “for Dummies” book treats a workshop: what the bench is for, which lever spends a credit, and the mistake that publishes a private list to the open web.

Base44’s own quick start is the definition worth keeping. It is an AI-powered website and app builder. You do not need coding skills. You describe what you want, and Base44 builds it — design, database, signups, permissions, and hosting included. The homepage line is “Every builder needs a base.”

Five names do the confusing. The app is what visitors use. The editor is where you build it, chat on the left and preview on the right. Credits are the meter. Publish is the moment a link goes live. A Superagent is a persistent assistant, in beta in the docs, that watches tools and takes action. This book keeps those five apart.

> PLAIN ENGLISH
> Vibe coding, in Base44’s own heading, means you describe the thing and the builder writes it. You are still responsible for what the thing stores and who can open it.

What this edition is, and is not

This is the 2026 Edition, prepared as an independent study guide by Er. Rishabh Aryan, M.Tech (Artificial Intelligence and Data Science), Department of Computer Science and Engineering, Indian Institute of Information Technology, Bhagalpur (Bihar). It is not published by Base44 or Wix, and it is not part of the Wiley “For Dummies” series. The dark field and orange follow the public builder aesthetic. The four-square mark on the cover was drawn for this manual and is not the Base44 trademark.

Feature names follow the public documentation at docs.base44.com: the quick start, the AI chat page, billing and plans, the design-system page, and the Superagent guide. Wix’s own blog states that Base44 joined Wix in June 2025 and later launched a proprietary model, Base 1. Prices and credit bundles move. Confirm them on base44.com/pricing before you pay.

> WATCH OUT
> A published annual price in this book is a snapshot of the public plans page, not a quote. Yearly billing was showing a discount. Monthly, regional, and Elite-level figures can differ.

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CHAPTER 01

Base44, without the mythology

Before the prompt, it helps to know you are building a hosted app, not renting a chat.

You open base44.com, or the iOS or Android app, and describe a thing. The quick start's examples are ordinary and useful: a to-do list, an event signup, a survey, a sales dashboard, a booking system, a private file share, a community with chat. The same bench also builds websites, with a separate getting-started path for pages, a domain, and search visibility.

Behind the preview, Base44 keeps the parts people usually assemble by hand: pages, a database, user accounts, permissions, and hosting. You can still open the code on plans that allow in-app edits, and from Builder upward you can export. You do not have to.

The five names

Name	In plain English
App	The product visitors use. It has pages, data, and usually a login.
Editor	Chat on the left, preview on the right, publish in the top bar.
Message credit	The meter for building: a prompt that changes the app.
Integration credit	The meter for the app's own calls: email, payments, connectors.
Superagent	A persistent assistant that connects to tools and runs tasks. Docs mark it beta.
Workspace	The account boundary. Members share its plan and its credit pool.

Names used in the rest of this manual.

What it is not

- Not a slide generator. If the result must store a signup, it is an app, and the data rules apply.
- Not Wix the website builder, though Base44 joined Wix in June 2025 and can take Wix payments. Wix is templates and a site editor. Base44 is a described app.
- Not Grok Build or Hermes. Those are other agents. Base44 is a hosted builder with its own credit meter and its own publish button.

> **REMEMBER**
> The docs state that Base44 does not claim ownership of what you create. You may use, modify, distribute, or sell it. Hosting and export rules are a separate sentence from ownership.

CHAPTER 02

From a sentence to a preview

The quick start is five moves. Most failed apps fail on the first sentence, not the fifth.

The documented path is: describe the idea, watch the app appear, customise it, test it as a visitor, then publish. You can also start from a plan conversation, from an existing URL you have the right to use, from a community or workspace template, or from a Figma file inside a design system.

A prompt that builds

- Who opens it, and what they are trying to finish.
- The objects it stores. A signup stores a name, a slot, and a reminder flag.
- The verbs: add, filter, export, cancel.
- Who may see what. Public page, signed-in page, admin page.
- One sentence on look. Quiet and dense, or loud and campaign. Not both.

Plan mode, in the quick start, is the conversation before the build: talk the app through, then turn the plan into a build. Use it when the data model is still fuzzy. A fuzzy data model is how you get a pretty screen that cannot answer “who is booked on Thursday.”

The editor

The app editor is the bench. AI chat on the left, preview on the right, and the bar above for editing, the Dashboard, and publishing. On a phone the preview fills the screen and Chat to Edit opens the conversation. The docs are frank that some controls stay on desktop: Edit mode, data permissions, code editing, APIs, and templates.

> TIP
> Attach the sketch, the spreadsheet, or the brand note to the first prompt. The chat box accepts files. A description of a form is weaker than the form.

CHAPTER 03

Build, Discuss, and Edit

Three modes. Only one of them changes the app as you type.

The AI chat page names the split. Build acts on the prompt. Discuss lets you ask or plan, and does not change code until you approve. You switch with the mode button, or with Cmd+. on a Mac and Ctrl+. on Windows. Edit is the third gesture: click an element in the preview and adjust it directly. Undo and redo in a visual edit session go up to 50 steps.

Discuss is not free of the meter. The chat page prices a Discuss message at 0.3 credits. Edit-mode changes that call the AI also spend message credits, scaled to size. You can queue up to 7 messages.

Models

The model icon at the bottom of the chat picks the engine. The chat page lists Auto, Base 1, Sonnet 5.5, Opus 5.5, Gemini 3.8 Flash, GPT-5.6 Terra, GPT-6.1 Sol, GPT 6 Astra, and Fable 5.1. Auto matches a model to the request. Model selection as a plan highlight begins at Builder. A side-by-side model comparison, on that same page, needs Builder or higher, costs 2× credits, and does not take attachments. Names in the picker will move. The habit will not: pick Auto until a specific failure tells you to pin a model.

Approval, instructions, revert

Auto approve, under More options next to Build, lets routine steps run without a pause. Changes that widen access to your data still ask. Custom instructions, in the same menu, are guidance applied to every prompt — a standing voice, a banned pattern, a component you always want.

Revert is per message: hover the prompt and use the revert icon. Version history sits at the top of the chat if you need an older published state. Clone the app before a risky rewrite. The quick start documents clone from the Apps page or from Dashboard, Settings, Create Copy.

> **WATCH OUT**
> Auto approve is a speed switch, not a judgement switch. Leave it off the first day, and leave it off whenever the prompt mentions permissions, payments, or deleting records.

CHAPTER 04

Credits and plans

Two meters, not one. Building spends message credits. The live app spends integration credits.

A workspace has a plan and a shared pool. Members do not each need a paid seat. Roles on every plan are Owner, Editor, and Viewer. Business and Enterprise add Admin. Invite is unlimited; the pool is not.

Free workspaces, on the plans documentation, receive 5 message credits a day, capped at 25 a month, plus a starter bundle of integration credits. People who only view a static app spend little. They still spend integration credits when they hit a feature that calls out — an email, a payment, a connector.

The ladder, as the billing page lists it

	Free	Starter	Builder	Pro
Message credits	25 / mo	100	250	500
Integration credits	100	2,000	10,000	20,000
Apps	Up to 5	Unlimited	Unlimited	Unlimited
Code edits	—	Yes	Yes	Yes
Backend functions	—	—	Yes	Yes
Domain	—	Connect	Connect	Connect
GitHub	—	—	Yes	Yes
Model select	—	—	Yes	Yes
Early beta	—	—	—	Yes

From the billing documentation. Elite adds premium support and higher credit levels. Business and Enterprise add SSO, residency, and governance. Confirm the live grid before purchase.

The public pricing page has shown yearly figures in the region of $16 a month for Starter, $40 for Builder, and $160 for an Elite level, with a yearly discount advertised. Those are not promises. A free domain for one year, and 25 credits to share, are documented as yearly-plan perks on the rungs that include them.

Starter is also where the billing page lists removal of the “Edit with Base44” platform badge. Backend functions start at Builder. Private apps are refused on Free in the workspaces documentation: Free builds public apps only.

> **REMEMBER**
> Backend functions cost credits, and they start at Builder. A pretty frontend on Free is not a backend. If the app must send mail or run a job on a timer, read the rung before you design the feature.

CHAPTER 05

Data, login, and design

The screen is the easy part. The table, and who may read it, is the app.

Authentication, database, and analytics are listed as core features even on Free. Data lives in tables the product calls entities. The Dashboard is where you view, edit, import, and export that data. Permissions decide which role sees which row. Set them before you publish, not after a stranger has exported the table.

A design system

A design system is workspace-level: logo, name, tagline, colours, fonts, tone, and components. Create it under the workspace name, Settings, Design system. New apps can start on it, so the second app does not invent a new orange. You may describe the brand, import one Figma file (the docs cap the upload at 1.9 GB and say the original file is not stored), or paste a site URL you have the right to use.

Generate a palette or a logo if you do not have one. Mark one logo primary. Tone of voice is a list of traits the builder is meant to keep. Put the rule there once, rather than restating it in every prompt.

> **TIP**
> Decide the empty state in the prompt: what a new user sees before the first row exists. An app that opens on a blank table looks broken even when it is not.

CHAPTER 06

Publish, domain, and export

Publish is a switch. Unpublish keeps the data. The badge is a separate decision.

Publish sits in the top bar. The panel opens on a Web tab, with a Mobile app tab beside it. From there you copy the address, get a domain, share, set visibility, check security status, and put the latest changes live. After publish, the confirmation shows the address and the next steps, including a custom domain.

Unpublish is under Dashboard, Settings, Danger Zone. People cannot open the app until you publish again. Data and settings remain. Clone if you want a sandbox for a breaking change; the copy opens with a “(Copy)” suffix.

The platform badge

A public app can show “Edit with Base44” at the bottom right. Clicking it copies the app into the clicker’s account. A private app does not show the badge. Removing it is a Starter-and-above control, toggled in Dashboard, Settings. If the app is a client deliverable, hide the badge on purpose. If it is a portfolio piece, the badge is a distribution channel.

Mobile and export

Publish on a custom domain and Base44 turns on core progressive-web features, so a visitor can add the app to a home screen. The docs also describe preparing store builds from the editor: a guideline scan, AI fixes, and IPA and AAB files for upload in your own Apple and Google developer accounts. That is not the same as Base44 submitting the store listing for you.

On Builder or higher, export from the top-right of the editor to GitHub or a ZIP. The documented export is client code — HTML, CSS, JavaScript, assets — and backend functions. Export is the exit. Use it before a plan lapse if the app matters.

> **WATCH OUT**
> Public plus the badge means a stranger can fork the app into their account. Private means they cannot. Choose visibility in the publish panel, not after the link has been forwarded.

CHAPTER 07

Superagents

An app waits for a visitor. A Superagent is documented as a persistent assistant that can act while you are away.

The Superagent guide, filed under a beta heading, says: tell it what you need, and it can turn everyday work into tasks, updates, reports, and automated actions. It can sit as an assistant, a support rep, a marketer, or an analyst. It connects to tools such as Google Workspace, Slack, GitHub, Notion, and HubSpot. It can run a daily summary or a weekly report, and it can speak through chat, WhatsApp, or Telegram. Voice is a microphone icon in its chat.

You build one from Superagents, Create a new Superagent, then a description of the outcome. It suggests connectors and tasks. Plugins split into connectors — the services — and skills it can run. A Gmail connector that drafts, rather than sends, is the right first shape.

App versus Superagent

Build the app when a person must click through a flow you own: a booking page, a portal, a survey. Build a Superagent when the job is a watch: new mail, a missed booking, a morning brief. Many workspaces want both, in that order. The app defines the data. The agent reads it.

> **REMEMBER**
> A Superagent with send permission is a colleague who does not sleep. Approve the draft. Do not grant send on the first afternoon, and do not point it at a mailbox you cannot revoke.

CHAPTER 08

A first-week practice plan

Seven short sessions. One app. Credits spent on purpose.

Day 1 — One sentence, one object

Create a workspace. Describe a tracker you will actually open: reading log, experiment log, office hour signup. Name the fields. Stop when the preview shows an empty state that tells a new user what to do.

Day 2 — Discuss, then Build

In Discuss, ask what breaks if two people book the same slot. Approve one change into Build. Revert it. The undo is the lesson.

Day 3 — Permissions

Add a visitor view and an admin view. Sign out in the preview and confirm the visitor cannot export. This is the day most portfolios skip.

Day 4 — A design system

Set a name, two colours, and a type pair at workspace level. Rebuild one screen so it inherits them. Do not restyle by begging the chat.

Day 5 — Publish private, then decide

Publish. Copy the link. Open it in a private window. If the plan is Free, expect a public app and the badge. Upgrade only if privacy or the badge is the actual requirement.

Day 6 — A domain or an export

On a paid rung, connect a domain or export a ZIP and read the files. Knowing the exit is part of choosing the bench.

Day 7 — One Superagent, no send

If you need a morning note, create a Superagent that drafts it. Do not connect a send action. Read the draft. That is the week.

> **TIP**
> Keep the prompts that worked, with the field list attached. A mood board will not rebuild the app. The field list will.

APPENDIX

Glossary

If a chapter and a glossary line disagree, follow the chapter. If the product and this book disagree, follow the product.

Term	Means
Auto approve	Routine build steps run without a pause. Data-access changes still ask.
Builder	The rung where backend functions, GitHub, and model selection are listed.
Discuss	Plan without editing code until you approve. Documented at 0.3 credits a message.
Entity	A data table the app stores.
Integration credit	Meter for the live app's outside calls.
Message credit	Meter for building in the chat.
Platform badge	"Edit with Base44" on a public app. Clicking it copies the app.
Publish	Puts the latest version on its address. Unpublish hides it and keeps data.
Superagent	Persistent assistant, beta in the docs, connected to tools and schedules.
Workspace	Shared plan, shared credits, Owner / Editor / Viewer.

Sources used for this edition

- docs.base44.com quick start — definition, five steps, publish, clone, badge.
- AI chat documentation — Build, Discuss, Edit, models, auto approve, revert, credit notes.
- Billing and plans — credit bundles and rung highlights.
- Workspaces documentation — roles, Free daily credits, ownership, private apps on Free.
- Design system and Superagent guides.
- Wix blog, on Base44 joining Wix in June 2025 and the Base 1 model.

COLOPHON

About this edition

Base44 for Dummies, 2026 Edition, is an independent plain-language manual. It explains the builder, the credit meters, publish, and Superagents for a reader who wants the bench, not the pitch.

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Notice

Base44 and Wix are names of their respective owners, used here to identify the product this guide describes. This manual is not affiliated with, endorsed by, or published by Base44 or Wix. It is not affiliated with Wiley and is not an official title in the For Dummies series. “For Dummies” is used in the ordinary sense of a plain-language introduction.

Feature descriptions were compiled from public documentation for the 2026 Edition. Credits, model names, and plan gates change. The workspace on your account is the authority.

2026 EDITION

No calendar day is printed in this edition, by design.